

Meridian Coffee Roasters
Employee Handbook

Revision 7, effective 1 March 2025.

This handbook supersedes all previous versions. It is not an employment contract.

1. Employment Basics

All new employees serve a probationary period of 90 calendar days. During probation either party may end the employment relationship with one week of notice. After probation the notice period is four weeks for both parties.

Employment is confirmed in writing by the People team. Verbal offers are not binding on the company.

Meridian is an equal opportunity employer. Hiring, promotion and compensation decisions are made without regard to race, colour, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability or veteran status.

2. Working Hours

The standard working week is 40 hours. Production staff work one of three fixed shifts: 05:00-13:30, 13:00-21:30, or 21:00-05:30. Shift assignments rotate on a four-week cycle and are published at least fourteen days in advance.

Corporate and support staff set their own hours within a core window of 10:00 to 15:00 Pacific time, during which they are expected to be reachable.

Overtime for hourly staff is paid at 1.5 times the base rate beyond 40 hours in a week, and at 2.0 times on company holidays. Overtime must be approved in advance by a shift lead. Unapproved overtime is still paid, but repeated instances are addressed through the performance process.

3. Remote and Hybrid Work

Roles that do not require physical presence may work remotely up to three days per week. Fully remote arrangements require director approval and are reviewed every six months.

Production, warehouse and retail roles are on-site by nature and are not eligible for remote work. The company does not offer a stipend for home office equipment, but will ship a laptop, monitor and chair on request.

Employees working remotely must be within four hours of Pacific time unless an exception is granted. Employees may work from outside the United States for up to fifteen working days per calendar year, subject to written approval from both their manager and the People team at least thirty days ahead.

4. Leave and Time Off

Full-time employees accrue 22 days of paid annual leave per year, accruing at 1.83 days per month from the first day of employment. Leave may be taken during probation with manager approval.

Up to five unused days may be carried into the following year. They expire on 31 March. Days beyond five are forfeited at year end and are not paid out, except on termination, where all accrued and unused leave is paid at the base rate.

Paid sick leave is 10 days per year and does not accrue or carry over. A doctor's note is required for absences longer than three consecutive days.

Parental leave is 16 weeks at full pay for the primary caregiver and 8 weeks at full pay for the secondary caregiver, available after 12 months of service. Bereavement leave is 5 days for an immediate family member and 2 days otherwise.

5. Compensation and Benefits

Salaries are reviewed once per year, in March, with any change effective 1 April. Meridian benchmarks against the 60th percentile of the Portland market for comparable roles.

Health insurance begins on the first day of the month following the start date. The company pays 85 percent of the employee premium and 60 percent of dependent premiums.

The retirement plan matches employee contributions dollar for dollar up to 4 percent of salary. Matching contributions vest immediately; there is no vesting cliff.

All employees receive two 340 g bags of coffee per month at no cost, and a 40 percent discount on all products for personal use. The discount may not be used to buy for resale.

Employees who refer a candidate who is hired and completes probation receive a 1,000 dollar referral bonus, paid in the following payroll cycle.

6. Performance

Formal performance reviews are held twice a year, in February and August. Reviews are written by the direct manager and countersigned by a director. Ratings do not follow a forced distribution.

Employees may request a written response to any review, which is retained in the personnel file alongside the review itself.

7. Conduct

Employees must disclose any outside employment or consulting that touches the coffee, food or beverage industry. Other outside work does not require disclosure but must not be performed during working hours or with company equipment.

Gifts from suppliers with a value above 75 dollars must be declined or surrendered to the People team. Meals and samples in the ordinary course of business are exempt.

Harassment and discrimination are grounds for immediate dismissal. Reports may be made to any manager, to the People team, or through the anonymous reporting line, which is operated by a third party and does not log caller identity.

The company prohibits retaliation against anyone who makes a report in good faith or participates in an investigation.

8. Health and Safety

Closed-toe shoes are mandatory anywhere in the roasting and warehouse areas. Hearing protection is mandatory within three metres of an operating roaster.

All production staff complete a safety induction before their first shift and a refresher every twelve months. Records are kept for five years.

Any injury, however minor, must be reported to a shift lead before the end of the shift in which it occurred. Near misses must also be reported; the company does not discipline employees for reporting near misses.

9. Equipment and Information

Company laptops are issued to corporate and support staff and remain company property. Personal use is permitted within reason.

Employees must use the company password manager for all work accounts. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory on email, payroll and the production systems. Passwords may not be shared, including with a manager.

Customer data may not be copied to personal devices or personal cloud storage. Requests to export customer data require written approval from a director.

Lost or stolen devices must be reported within 24 hours so the device can be remotely wiped.

10. Leaving the Company

Resigning employees give four weeks of notice after probation. The company may waive part of the notice period but will pay it in full where it does so.

On the final day, employees return their laptop, keys, badge and any company credit card to their manager. Final pay, including all accrued and unused annual leave, is issued on the next scheduled payroll date and not earlier.

Access to email and internal systems is revoked at 18:00 on the final working day. Employees who wish to retain personal files should export them beforehand and may ask the People team for help doing so.

Alumni remain eligible for the 40 percent product discount for twelve months.